

夜の穴 — Chapter 1 "Blue Light" — English

It was a rainy night. Ken is a thirteen-year-old boy. He lives in a small village. Maru is Ken's dog. He isn't big. But he's strong. Ken was running near the forest with Maru. Suddenly, a sound came from inside the forest. "Maru — that sound just now. What was it?" "Woof!" Maru went into the forest. "Ah! Maru!" Ken went in too. The night forest was blue. Inside the forest, they saw a blue light. The light was coming out of a hole at the base of the mountain. The rain stopped. The moon came out in the sky. On the grass there was an old stone. Square, and white. There is writing on the stone: "The king's treasure lies below. There is money, too."

"Treasure...!" Ken thought. "A king? Under *this* mountain?" Ken's heart went *thump thump*. Maru's ears stood up. From inside the hole — a sound. The sound of big footsteps. The sound came closer. Ken's body froze. "Maru, run!" But Maru didn't run. Maru stood at the mouth of the hole and said: "Ken. Let's go in." Huh?! Did the dog just TALK?!

to be continued

Next time: A: Go into the hole with Maru / B: Run back to the village